

MUGDHA KALRA,
Mother of **MADHAV,**
13, Mumbai

Acceptance was everything for Mugdha Kalra, a broadcast journalist. Parents go through a grief cycle when the diagnosis of autism first arrives, she says. "It is the death of a dream. My life changed from that moment." Kalra is grateful that she can afford therapies and special school for her son, which otherwise is expensive to sustain. It also helps that her husband is equally hands-on when it comes to special needs parenting. Her choices have come from Madhav's condition, on what makes him most comfortable. Instagram has provided this autism activist with a platform to spread awareness and share stories about Madhav, something unavailable to parents previously. The neurodiversity movement in India is being driven by parents like Kalra who are making parenting a child with autism relatable and understandable.